Harlesden Lodge 2098

Etiquette for Responding to Summons and Dining Arrangements

Our Ancient Charge

Brethren, we are reminded of our fundamental obligations as outlined in our Ancient Charge:

*"Your Obedience must be proved by a strict observance of our laws and regulations; **by prompt attention to all signs and summonses**; by modest and correct demeanour in the Lodge; by abstaining from every topic of political or religious discussion; by a ready acquiescence in all votes and resolutions duly passed by a majority of the Brethren; and by a perfect submission to the Master and his wardens, while acting in the discharge of their respective offices."*

This sacred obligation forms the foundation of our fraternal conduct and extends to all aspects of Lodge administration, including our response to summonses and dining arrangements.

Essential Requirements

1. Prompt Response to Summonses

In accordance with our Ancient Charge regarding "*prompt attention to all signs and summonses*," it is **imperative that you respond as soon as possible** upon receiving any Lodge Summons. Your timely response enables proper planning and demonstrates respect for the Lodge and your Brethren.

2. Advance Payment for Dining

All dining fees must be paid **in advance** before the specified cut-off date via electronic transfer to the Lodge account. Should electronic payment not be possible for any reason, members must **inform the Treasurer in advance** to arrange alternative payment methods, as handling cash transactions requires additional administrative preparation.

This requirement ensures:

- Accurate headcount for catering arrangements
- Proper financial management of Lodge resources
- Respect for our dining establishment partners
- Efficient handling of payment administration

3. Cancellation Policy
Should circumstances require you to cancel your attendance or dining participation **after the cut-off date**, please be aware that **refunds cannot be guaranteed**. Each dining establishment operates according to different policies regarding advance orders and cancellations. The Lodge endeavours to secure refunds where possible, but members should understand that late cancellations may result in forfeited fees due to food orders placed in good faith based on confirmed numbers.

4. Guest Responsibilities
Members who bring guests to Lodge dining bear full financial responsibility for their guests' participation.

This responsibility includes:

- Ensuring guest payment is arranged prior to the event
- Personal liability for any unpaid guest dining fees
- Clear communication with guests regarding payment expectations

The hosting member remains accountable for all guest-related charges, regardless of individual guest payment arrangements.

Fraternal Courtesy

These protocols exist not as burdensome regulations, but as expressions of our commitment to fraternal harmony and efficient Lodge administration. By adhering to these guidelines, each Brother contributes to the smooth operation of our Lodge and demonstrates consideration for fellow members and Lodge officers.
Your cooperation in observing these courtesies is both appreciated and expected, reflecting the high standards of conduct that distinguish our ancient and honourable fraternity.

Compiled for the benefit of all Brethren of Harlesden Lodge No. 2098